



Figure 3: The App settings screen lets you choose Per App DPI and Per App Colour



Figure 4: The Pie Controls in extended desktop mode



Figure 5: The 'Settings' screen for Pie Controls and the HALO interface

and detailed settings that are available in the Paranoid Android Preferences App, which can be accessed as 'Hybrid Properties' from the 'Settings' screen. One can choose from the Stock UI, Phablet UI and the various Tablet UIs from the main screen (Figure 1). Further settings can be accessed from the menu by swiping left on this screen. The interface menu, for example, takes you to a screen that allows you to change the size and colour of various screen elements like the navigation bar and status bar (Figure 2). The 'Apps' screen, on the other hand, provides similar options for individual apps, even allowing you to choose which apps need to be opened in expanded desktop mode, and letting you choose the pixel density and status bar colour for each app (Figure 3).

Pie Controls

The Pie Controls feature is an innovative way of navigating the Android interface, and is meant to replace the on-screen navigation buttons that come with most devices like those in Nexus phones and tablets. While it might be redundant on devices with hardware buttons, it still is beautiful enough for everyone to give it a try. The ROM allows users to customise various options related to the trigger area, alignment, speed, size, etc. These configuration options related to Pie can be changed from the 'Toolbars' menu in the 'Settings' screen (Figure 5). This same menu also allows changing options related to the HALO interface. The Pie Controls can look

particularly beautiful when opened in the 'Extended desktop' mode. This mode replaces the status bar, to move all the details that it provides onto the screen when the Pie Controls feature is triggered. The way its fan-out transition has grown to be more and more fluid over the years, is the result of the hard work put in by the developers who have re-written its code base to ensure that there are no hiccups whatsoever.

Personally, I prefer to configure Pie on the right edge of the screen, where it feels more natural to right-handed users like me and can be triggered effortlessly with the thumb. This provides for much more natural, fluid and effortless navigation. While the direction for each action might take some getting used to, once you do get accustomed to it, this looks much cooler to show off and obviously saves screen space.

HALO multi-tasking

HALO is a recently released feature by the Paranoid Android team, and is possibly one of the biggest developments in AOSP-based ROMs till date. It brings forward the possibilities for true multi-tasking applications with floating windows, to avoid having to completely switch to an application that takes up the whole screen. It also incorporates one of the few innovative features of the Facebook Messenger app, and extends it to implement a similar chat head like a notification system for every notification in Android. A small bubble pops up whenever